



Bikes in battle

Land

Rikuo Type 97 Japan 1933



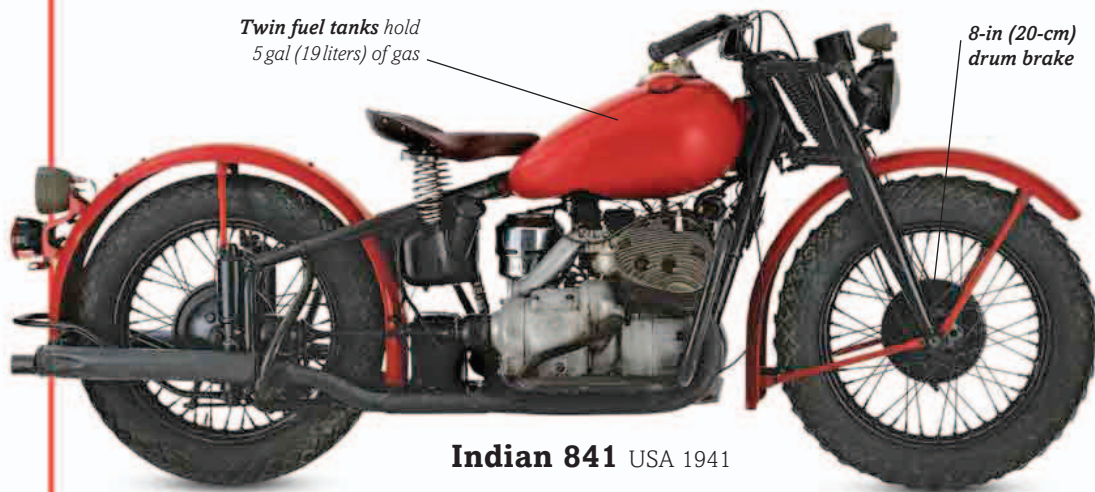
Sidecar wheel powered by the motorcycle's 745 cc engine

Headlight hood to mask the Sun's glare, which could give away the bike's position



BMW R12 Germany 1940

Twin fuel tanks hold 5 gal (19 liters) of gas

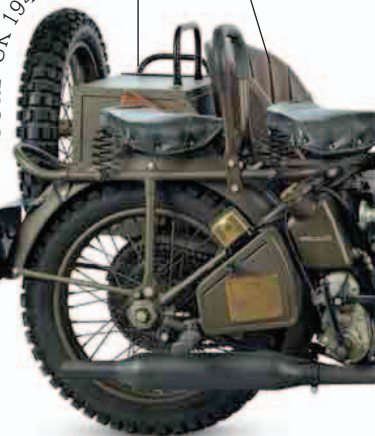


Indian 841 USA 1941

8-in (20-cm) drum brake

Steel frame for heavy panniers that could hold ammunition

Norton Big Four Sidecar UK 1940



Sidecar

As motorcycles became faster, sturdier, and more reliable, they were adopted by armed forces in their thousands. World War II saw heavy motorcycle use, as scouts, in convoys, and as couriers, transporting messages and people.

Many World War II motorcycles were adapted civilian models. More than 70,000 **Harley-Davidson WLAs** were made for the American forces, while 126,000 **BSA M20s** were built by the UK and its allies—making it the most produced motorcycle of the war. A prewar Harley-Davidson